

Breathing Through “FIRST-TIME SILICON SUCCESS”

No one is born a leader, but the choices we make in life propel us to become a leader. For Chitra Hariharan, an innocent fascination for electronic appliances, which were slowly entering the Indian markets then, pushed her to make it big into the miniaturising world of electronics. With four successful silicon and electronics product startup exits, Chitra has led the chip design ecosystem for 35 years, contributing to almost 125 semiconductor products. She dreamed of making a difference and dared to choose the unconventional path, never giving up on an opportunity—she seized it and ran with it. This is Chitra Hariharan’s story as narrated to EFY’s Yashasvini Razdan

**CHITRA
HARIHARAN**
RENESAS INDIA



Born into a lower-middle-class family in South Tamil Nadu to a state government employee father, Rajagopal, and a homemaker mother, Gowri, Chitra had a modest upbringing. Within the confines of their 1HK house, Chitra watched her father shuttle from one place to another, engaging with weavers’ associations, working hard to educate his two daughters.

“Our monthly treat, that *Amma* bought for us, was a small cream